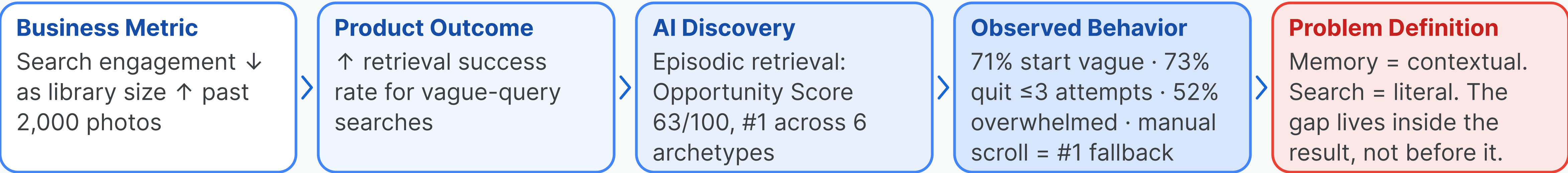


Memory Keepers Cannot Narrow a Flood of Similar Photos:
Retrieval Ends Exactly When Their Memory Fails

Problem Framing Canvas

HOW THE THINKING EVOLVED



THE RETRIEVAL SCENARIO WE ARE SOLVING FOR: User searches "Goa trip" or "café with friends." Gets 1,000 similar photos. Cannot move closer to the one they need. Exits to manual scrolling or gives up. Large library. Vague input. No path forward after results land.

TARGET SEGMENT: MEMORY KEEPERS
Smartphone users aged 22-38 with 2,000-10,000+ photos who search for specific past moments using vague emotional memory, not keywords. ~35% of active users. High intent, metadata-poor recall.

ROOT CAUSE
Gap 1: memory is contextual (event, era, vibe, people), search is indexed on metadata (date, GPS, object tag): they barely overlap. Gap 2: no navigation layer in results to sub-group or move closer.

VALUE FOR THE USER
Find the photo they can picture but cannot describe. End the 3-attempt give-up loop. Replace manual scrolling with a directed path. Turn a dead end into a navigable result set.

PRODUCT OUTCOME TO INFLUENCE
Increase the % of Memory Keepers who retrieve the target photo in their first search session, without falling back to timeline scrolling. Metric: retrieval success rate, vague queries, 2,000+ photos.

EXISTING USER WORKAROUNDS

52% scroll the timeline: 15-25 min per failed search

31% loop back guessing synonyms

24% go broader, making results worse

WHY IT MAKES BUSINESS SENSE
79% dissatisfied after search: a majority failing on a core surface. 17% already exit to scrolling. Retrieval trust = storage trust. Fix once, benefit repeats every session.